

Document 1. SEAB 9570 Syllabus Map

A-Worthy Education | H2 Economics 9570 Study Suite

Annotated checklist of learning outcomes, assessment structure and suite coverage.

Author: Jeremy Lim | Brand: A-Worthy Education | @telephonemepls on Telegram

How to use this Syllabus Map. Each learning outcome is presented as a printable checklist item (☐). Tick the box once you can (a) define each key term, (b) draw and explain the relevant diagram, (c) apply the concept to a Singapore policy example, and (d) answer a past-paper question that tests the outcome. The final section maps every learning outcome to the document in the A-Worthy suite that covers it in depth.

Section A. Overview of the 9570 Syllabus

The Singapore-Cambridge GCE A-Level H2 Economics syllabus (9570) is set jointly by the Singapore Examinations and Assessment Board (SEAB) and Cambridge Assessment International Education. It is examinable for the 2026 cohort onward.

Aims of the Syllabus

The 9570 syllabus aims to develop in candidates:

1. An understanding of fundamental economic concepts, theories and principles, and of the tools and methods of analysis used by economists.
2. The ability to use the tools and methods of economic reasoning to explain and analyse economic issues, and to evaluate the perspectives and decisions of economic agents.
3. The habit of reading critically from a variety of sources to gain information about changing economic activity and policy at the national and international levels.
4. The ability to use evidence in making well-reasoned economic arguments and to arrive at rational and considered decisions.

Assessment Objectives

- **AO1 — Knowledge and understanding.** Demonstrate knowledge and understanding of economic concepts, theories and principles.
- **AO2 — Application and interpretation.** Interpret economic information presented in textual, numerical or graphical form, and apply economic concepts to analyse contemporary issues.
- **AO3 — Analysis and evaluation.** Make valid inferences and construct coherent, evidence-based economic arguments to evaluate perspectives and decisions.

Paper Structure

Paper	Format	Skills tested	Duration	Weighting
Paper 1	Two compulsory Case Study Questions (CSQs). One micro, one macro.	AO1, AO2, AO3	2 h 15 min	40%
Paper 2	Three essays from a choice of six (Section A micro; Section B macro).	AO1, AO2, AO3	2 h 15 min	60%

NOTE: Paper 1 typically contains one micro and one macro CSQ; Paper 2 essays are split into Section A (micro, three questions) and Section B (macro, three questions). Candidates must answer at least one essay from each section.

Three Themes of the Syllabus

1. **Theme 1 — The Central Economic Problem.**
2. **Theme 2 — Markets.** Microeconomics: the price mechanism and its applications.
3. **Theme 3 — The National and International Economy.** Macroeconomics: aggregate analysis, macroeconomic aims, and policy.

Section B. Theme 1 — The Central Economic Problem

Learning Outcomes

- ☐ Define scarcity, choice and opportunity cost.
- ☐ Explain why scarcity gives rise to the three central economic questions: *What to produce? How to produce? For whom to produce?*
- ☐ Define the Production Possibilities Curve (PPC), state its four assumptions, and identify points on, inside, and outside the curve.
- ☐ Explain why the PPC is concave to the origin (law of increasing opportunity cost).
- ☐ Distinguish between a movement along the PPC and a shift of the PPC (actual vs. potential growth).
- ☐ Explain how changes in the quantity or quality of factors of production, or technology, shift the PPC.
- ☐ Distinguish between a parallel outward shift and a pivot in the PPC.
- ☐ Use the PPC to illustrate the trade-off between current consumption and future consumption.
- ☐ Distinguish between positive and normative economic statements.
- ☐ Identify the three economic agents (consumers, producers, government) and explain the goals and constraints of each.

Section C. Theme 2 — Markets (Microeconomics)

C1. Demand, Supply and Market Equilibrium

- ☐ Define demand, supply, and equilibrium in a competitive market.
- ☐ Explain the law of demand and the law of supply.
- ☐ State and explain the determinants of demand (**P-TIDE**: Price of related goods, Taste, Income, Demographics, Expectations).
- ☐ State and explain the determinants of supply (**CPPSE**: Cost of production, Prices of related goods, Producers, Supply shocks, Expectations).
- ☐ Distinguish between a movement along, and a shift of, the demand or supply curve.
- ☐ Explain how the price mechanism performs the *signalling*, *incentive* and *rationing* functions in resource allocation.

- ☐ Analyse how a change in demand or supply (or both) affects equilibrium price and quantity, consumer expenditure, producer revenue, consumer surplus, and producer surplus.

C2. Elasticities of Demand and Supply

- ☐ Define and compute Price Elasticity of Demand (PED), Income Elasticity of Demand (YED), Cross Elasticity of Demand (CED) and Price Elasticity of Supply (PES).
- ☐ State and explain the determinants of PED and PES (**SNIT**: Substitutes / Necessities, Income proportion, Time).
- ☐ State and explain the determinants of YED (**NL**: Nature of the good, Level of income).
- ☐ Interpret the sign and magnitude of CED and distinguish substitutes, complements and unrelated goods.
- ☐ Apply elasticity concepts to pricing strategies, output decisions, and total revenue analysis for firms.
- ☐ Apply elasticity concepts to government decisions (taxation, subsidy, exchange rate, buffer stock).
- ☐ Evaluate the limitations of elasticity concepts in practice.

C3. Producer Behaviour and Market Structures

- ☐ Distinguish short-run and long-run costs; explain fixed, variable, marginal and average costs.
- ☐ Explain economies and diseconomies of scale, and the difference between internal and external economies of scale.
- ☐ State the profit-maximisation condition: $MR = MC$ and MC cutting MR from below.
- ☐ Explain the short-run shut-down condition ($P < AVC$) and the long-run exit condition ($P < AC$).
- ☐ Distinguish the four market structures: *Perfect Competition*, *Monopolistic Competition*, *Oligopoly*, *Monopoly*.
- ☐ Compare each structure on number and size of firms, nature of product, barriers to entry, knowledge, and price/output decisions.
- ☐ Analyse short-run and long-run equilibrium in each market structure.
- ☐ Explain oligopolistic price and non-price strategies: kinked demand, price leadership, collusion (explicit and tacit), limit pricing, predatory pricing, price discrimination.
- ☐ Evaluate each market structure against allocative, productive, and dynamic efficiency, and against equity and consumer choice.
- ☐ Explain why oligopoly and monopolistic competition are the most common real-world market structures.
- ☐ Recognise alternative theories of the firm (sales-maximisation, growth-maximisation, satisficing).

C4. Market Failure

- ☐ Define market failure and distinguish it from government failure.
- ☐ Explain market failure arising from negative externalities (production and consumption), including derivation of MSC , MSB , the deadweight loss, and welfare analysis.
- ☐ Explain market failure arising from positive externalities (production and consumption), with the same welfare analysis.
- ☐ Define merit, demerit, and public goods. Explain the free-rider problem and the non-rivalry/non-excludability/non-rejectability properties.

- ☐ Explain market failure arising from imperfect information (under- and over-consumption), including asymmetric information, adverse selection, and moral hazard.
- ☐ Explain market failure arising from factor immobility and market dominance.
- ☐ Recognise that income inequality is a market *limitation* (lack of distributive efficiency), not a standard market failure.
- ☐ Evaluate government interventions: Pigouvian taxes, subsidies, tradable permits, regulations, outright ban, direct provision, R&D investment, education campaigns.
- ☐ Evaluate the risk of government failure when intervening.

C5. Government Intervention in Markets

- ☐ Analyse the effect of specific and ad valorem taxes on price, quantity, consumer surplus, producer surplus, government revenue, and welfare.
- ☐ Analyse the effect of per unit subsidies on the same variables.
- ☐ Analyse the effect of an effective price ceiling (set below equilibrium) and the resulting shortage, black market risk, and welfare loss.
- ☐ Analyse the effect of an effective price floor (set above equilibrium), including in the labour market (minimum wage), and the resulting surplus, unemployment risk, and welfare loss.
- ☐ Apply Singapore policy examples: GST, sin taxes, COE quota system, foreign worker levy, MediShield Life, Workfare, ITE/SkillsFuture subsidies, ComCare.

Section D. Theme 3 — The National and International Economy (Macroeconomics)

D1. Aggregate Demand, Aggregate Supply and National Income

- ☐ Define Aggregate Demand ($AD = C + I + G + (X - M)$) and identify the determinants of each component.
- ☐ Define Short-Run and Long-Run Aggregate Supply (SRAS, LRAS) and explain their shape.
- ☐ Define the Circular Flow of Income (4-sector model) and identify injections ($I + G + X$) and withdrawals ($S + T + M$).
- ☐ State the equilibrium condition: injections = withdrawals.
- ☐ Explain the multiplier process and compute the multiplier $k = 1/(1 - MPC) = 1/MPW$.
- ☐ Analyse the effect of changes in C , I , G or $(X - M)$ on equilibrium national income using the $AD-AS$ framework.
- ☐ Distinguish nominal vs. real GDP, GDP vs. GNP/GNI, and explain the conditions for these to be appropriate measures of economic performance.
- ☐ Explain why Singapore's C is small and its X and M are large, relative to other economies.

D2. Macroeconomic Aims and Trade-offs

- ☐ Identify the four macroeconomic aims: sustained economic growth, low and stable inflation, low unemployment, healthy balance of payments.
- ☐ Extend the aims to *sustainable* and *inclusive* growth.

- ☐ Explain potential trade-offs and conflicts: growth vs. price stability, growth vs. BOT, equity vs. efficiency, low unemployment vs. price stability (Phillips-style trade-off).
- ☐ Evaluate Singapore's policy mix in resolving conflicts among aims.

D3. Standard of Living

- ☐ Distinguish material and non-material aspects of Standard of Living (SOL).
- ☐ Use Real GDP per capita to compare SOL over time within a country, and identify its limitations.
- ☐ Use PPP-adjusted Real GNP per capita to compare SOL across countries, and identify its limitations.
- ☐ Apply supplementary indicators: Gini coefficient, HDI, PQLI, NEW, life expectancy, literacy.
- ☐ Apply Singapore SOL data points (Gini before/after taxes and transfers; HDI rank).

D4. Inflation and Deflation

- ☐ Define inflation and deflation. Distinguish demand-pull, cost-push (wage-push, profit-push, imported, statutory), and built-in inflation.
- ☐ Explain the consequences of high inflation: distorted price signals, shoe-leather and menu costs, redistribution of income, loss of trade competitiveness, dampening of savings and investment.
- ☐ Explain the deflationary spiral and why deflation is harmful.
- ☐ Evaluate policies to control inflation: contractionary fiscal/monetary policy, exchange rate revaluation, prices and incomes policies, long-run supply-side policies.
- ☐ Apply Singapore policy: MAS's exchange-rate-centred monetary policy as the primary anti-inflation tool.

D5. Unemployment

- ☐ Define unemployment and the unemployment rate.
- ☐ Distinguish cyclical (demand-deficient), structural, frictional and seasonal unemployment.
- ☐ Explain the consequences of unemployment for individuals, firms, the government, and the economy.
- ☐ Evaluate policies to address each type of unemployment.
- ☐ Apply Singapore policy: SkillsFuture, Workfare Skills Support, PCP (Professional Conversion Programme), Jobs Growth Incentive.

D6. Economic Growth

- ☐ Distinguish actual and potential economic growth, and represent each on a PPC and on an *AD-AS* diagram.
- ☐ Define sustained, sustainable, and inclusive growth.
- ☐ Explain the demand-side and supply-side causes of growth.
- ☐ Explain the benefits and costs of economic growth.
- ☐ Evaluate Singapore's pursuit of all three forms of growth (e.g. Research, Innovation and Enterprise plans; Green Plan 2030; ComCare; Progressive Wage Model).

D7. Balance of Payments

- ☐ Define the Balance of Payments (BOP) and identify the Current Account, Capital Account, and Financial Account.
- ☐ Distinguish Balance of Trade (BOT) from BOP. Identify the visible and invisible balances.
- ☐ Explain the causes and consequences of a persistent BOT/Current Account deficit, and of a persistent surplus.
- ☐ Evaluate expenditure-reducing, expenditure-switching, supply-side, and economic-integration policies for BOP correction.
- ☐ Apply the Marshall-Lerner condition: $PED_x + PED_m > 1$.
- ☐ Apply Singapore data points (persistent current account surplus, sovereign wealth funds).

D8. Exchange Rates

- ☐ Define the exchange rate and distinguish appreciation, depreciation, revaluation, devaluation.
- ☐ Compare the three exchange rate systems: *freely floating*, *fixed*, *managed float*.
- ☐ Analyse the effects of an appreciation and a depreciation on AD , AS , growth, inflation, unemployment, and BOT.
- ☐ Explain Singapore's managed-float system, the S\$NEER policy band, slope, width, and centre.
- ☐ Justify why exchange rate policy (not interest rate policy) is MAS's primary macroeconomic tool, given Singapore's open economy and high import content.

D9. Fiscal Policy

- ☐ Define fiscal policy and distinguish expansionary, contractionary, and balanced budget positions.
- ☐ Identify and explain the tools: direct and indirect taxation, transfer payments, government expenditure (operating and development).
- ☐ Explain the multiplier and crowding-out effects of fiscal policy.
- ☐ Evaluate the strengths and limitations of fiscal policy: time lags, debt accumulation, political feasibility, automatic stabilisers.
- ☐ Apply Singapore's annual Budget framework, MOF's fiscal prudence rule, and reserves protection (Net Investment Returns Contribution).

D10. Monetary Policy

- ☐ Distinguish interest-rate-centred monetary policy from exchange-rate-centred monetary policy.
- ☐ Explain the transmission mechanism from interest rate change $\rightarrow C, I, (X - M) \rightarrow AD$.
- ☐ Recognise the impossible trinity (open capital account, fixed exchange rate, independent monetary policy).
- ☐ Explain why Singapore (small, open, high import content) selects the exchange rate over the interest rate as its monetary policy tool.
- ☐ Apply MAS policy: tightening through faster S\$NEER appreciation; easing through slope flattening or band re-centring.
- ☐ Evaluate the limitations of monetary policy: zero lower bound, interest insensitivity, asset bubbles, hot-money flows.

D11. Supply-Side Policies

- ☐ Distinguish short-run (cost-reducing) and long-run (capacity-expanding) supply-side policies.
- ☐ Identify market-based supply-side policies: tax cuts, deregulation, labour market reforms.
- ☐ Identify interventionist supply-side policies: education and training, R&D, infrastructure, industrial policy, immigration.
- ☐ Evaluate the cost, time lag, and complementarity of supply-side policies with demand management.
- ☐ Apply Singapore policy: SkillsFuture, A*STAR, EDB industry development, Smart Nation, Green Plan 2030.

D12. International Trade and Comparative Advantage

- ☐ Define free trade and explain the law of comparative advantage in terms of opportunity cost.
- ☐ Compute and interpret terms of trade.
- ☐ Explain the gains from trade (consumer, producer, dynamic gains).
- ☐ Explain the costs of free trade (structural unemployment, over-reliance, externalities).
- ☐ Distinguish Free Trade Agreements (FTAs) and explain trade creation vs. trade diversion.

D13. Trade Policies and Protectionism

- ☐ Identify protectionist instruments: tariffs, quotas, export subsidies, voluntary export restraints, non-tariff barriers.
- ☐ Analyse the welfare effects of a tariff and a quota on consumers, producers, and government.
- ☐ Evaluate the arguments for protectionism: infant industry, anti-dumping, strategic industries, employment, sunset industries.
- ☐ Evaluate the arguments against protectionism: allocative inefficiency, retaliation, higher prices, reduced competition.

D14. Globalisation

- ☐ Define globalisation and identify its drivers (economic, technological, political).
- ☐ Identify its key flows (goods and services, capital, technology, labour).
- ☐ Evaluate the benefits and costs of globalisation, including the deglobalisation trend.
- ☐ Apply Singapore policy: open immigration, FTA network, GIC and Temasek as global investors.

Section E. Command Words and Assessment Skills

- ☐ **Identify / State.** Pick out a piece of information; no explanation required (1–2 marks).
- ☐ **Describe.** State the main features or trend without explanation (2–3 marks).
- ☐ **Explain.** Give reasons; show how / why something occurs (3–6 marks).
- ☐ **Account for.** Give reasons for an outcome or trend, usually using data.
- ☐ **Compare / Contrast.** Identify similarities and/or differences with reasons.
- ☐ **Analyse.** Break down a concept into parts and explain the relationships; usually requires a diagram.
- ☐ **Discuss.** Give two or more sides; consider strengths and weaknesses.

- ☐ **Evaluate / Assess / Comment / To what extent.** Make a judgement supported by evidence; weigh considerations; reach a reasoned conclusion.

NOTE: For 8-mark and above CSQ parts, a substantive evaluation point is expected. For Paper 2 essays, the typical mark allocation is 10 marks for the (a) part and 15 marks for the (b) part, with evaluation worth roughly one-third of the (b) total.

Section F. Suite Coverage Map

This table shows which document in the A-Worthy H2 Economics study suite covers each syllabus area in depth.

#	Document	Primary syllabus coverage
Tier 1 — Foundational Reference		
1	SEAB 9570 Syllabus Map (this document)	All themes — checklist
2	Command Word Grid	Assessment skills
3	Diagram Bank	All diagrammatic outcomes
4	Singapore Evidence Bank	Macro theme — Singapore policy facts
Tier 2 — Topical Concept Cheat Sheets		
5	Demand, Supply & Market Equilibrium	C1
6	Elasticities (PED, YED, XED, PES)	C2
7	Market Failure: Externalities	C4 (externalities)
8	Market Failure: Merit/Demerit/Public Goods + Info Failure	C4 (remaining sources)
9	Market Structures	C3
10	Government Intervention in Markets	C5
11	AD-AS Framework & National Income	D1
12	Macroeconomic Aims & Trade-offs	D2, D3
13	Inflation & Deflation	D4
14	Unemployment	D5
15	Economic Growth (Actual, Potential, Inclusive, Sustainable)	D6
16	Balance of Payments	D7
17	Exchange Rate Systems (incl. Singapore's managed float)	D8
18	Fiscal Policy	D9
19	Monetary Policy (incl. MAS exchange-rate MP)	D10
20	Supply-Side Policies	D11
21	International Trade & Comparative Advantage	D12
22	Trade Policies & Protectionism	D13
23	Globalisation	D14
Tier 3 — Application & Skills		
24	Evaluation Toolkit	AO3 — evaluation skills
25	Connector & Signposting Phrasebank	Writing skills
26	Timing Drill Protocols	Paper 1 & 2 pacing
27	Comparative Frameworks Sheet	Cross-topic syntheses
Tier 4 — Practice Sets		
28	CSQ Question-Type Drill Sets	Paper 1
29	Essay Plan Bank	Paper 2
30	Worked Essay Exemplars	Paper 2
31	Worked CSQ Solutions	Paper 1
Tier 5 — Diagnostic Templates		
32	Personal Error Log	Self-diagnosis
33	Topic Self-Assessment Tracker	Self-diagnosis
34	Mock Exam Schedule	Revision planning

Section G. Topic Mastery Self-Check

For each topic below, tick the box only after you can (a) state every definition without reference, (b) draw the canonical diagram from memory, (c) cite at least one Singapore policy example, and (d) score full marks on one past-paper question.

Topic	Defs	Diagram	SG ex.	Past Q
Central Economic Problem (PPC, Scarcity)	☐	☐	☐	☐
Demand, Supply, Market Equilibrium	☐	☐	☐	☐
Elasticities (PED, YED, XED, PES)	☐	☐	☐	☐
Market Failure: Externalities	☐	☐	☐	☐
Market Failure: Merit / Demerit / Public Goods	☐	☐	☐	☐
Market Failure: Information Failure	☐	☐	☐	☐
Market Structures (PC / MC / Oligopoly / Monopoly)	☐	☐	☐	☐
Government Intervention in Markets	☐	☐	☐	☐
AD-AS & National Income	☐	☐	☐	☐
Inflation & Deflation	☐	☐	☐	☐
Unemployment	☐	☐	☐	☐
Economic Growth (Actual / Potential / Sus / Inc)	☐	☐	☐	☐
Balance of Payments	☐	☐	☐	☐
Exchange Rate Systems (incl. MAS managed float)	☐	☐	☐	☐
Fiscal Policy	☐	☐	☐	☐
Monetary Policy (incl. MAS exchange-rate MP)	☐	☐	☐	☐
Supply-Side Policies	☐	☐	☐	☐
International Trade & Comparative Advantage	☐	☐	☐	☐
Trade Policies & Protectionism	☐	☐	☐	☐
Globalisation	☐	☐	☐	☐

Authoritative References.

- SEAB H2 Economics 9570 Syllabus, Year 2026 (official): seab.gov.sg/files/9570_y26_sy.pdf
- The Economics Tutor — H2 Economics Syllabus overview: theeconomicstutor.com/h2-economics-syllabus

NOTE: This Syllabus Map reflects the practitioner consensus reading of the 9570 syllabus. Where a sub-outcome paraphrases SEAB rather than quotes it verbatim, it is marked with the NOTE convention above. Always cross-check against the latest official PDF before the examination.